

Project Vuna

A digital platform for credit, certified inputs, and parametric drought insurance — bundled and delivered to South African smallholder farmers through their cooperatives.

The problem

Smallholders produce around 70% of Sub-Saharan Africa's food yet receive less than 5% of commercial bank lending. Crop-insurance penetration in Sub-Saharan Africa is below 3%. One failed season wipes out a family. Inputs are unaffordable, often counterfeit, and middlemen capture 40–60% of the final crop value.

The product

A registered farmer applies through her cooperative for a **Grow Pack** — a pre-configured bundle of certified seed, fertilizer, and a parametric drought policy. The cooperative reviews and approves. Suppliers deliver directly. At harvest, the cost is auto-deducted from sale proceeds. Each successful season builds a portable credit history.

Why we are reaching out

We do not seek to underwrite insurance. We seek a **licensed underwriting partner** who can issue the parametric crop policy while we provide:

- bullet Digital distribution into the smallholder market
- bullet Cooperative-mediated KYC and on-the-ground trust
- bullet Real-time data ingestion for parametric triggers
- bullet Automated, transparent payout execution
- bullet POPIA-compliant farmer data handling

What we offer the underwriter

- bullet A distribution channel into a market that is uneconomic to serve through brokers
- bullet Lower per-policy operating cost via automated payouts
- bullet Auditable, real-time policy and claims data
- bullet Public-impact alignment for development-finance and ESG reporting

Where we are

Hackathon-stage MVP for the Solana 2026 Frontier Hackathon. Complete product proposal, regulatory analysis (NCA, FAIS, FSCA, SARB, POPIA), and design mockups in hand. No real money deployed. We are speaking to a small number of South African agri-insurers before committing to an architecture.

Regulatory awareness

We understand that under the **FAIS Act** and the **Insurance Act 2017**, the parametric product must be underwritten by a licensed FSP and insurer. That is precisely why we are seeking a partner and not building this alone.

What we are asking for

A 30-minute introductory conversation in the next two weeks.

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